NEXUS LAUNCHER

User Guide

Everything your home screen can do, from the first swipe to the last widget.

Covers Nexus Launcher 1.0.2 · Android 8.0 and later
Last updated October 2026

Contents

1. Getting started
2. The home screen
3. Pages and the home layout
4. Gestures
5. The app drawer
6. Folders
7. The dock
8. Widgets
9. Nexus Canvas
10. Theme and appearance
11. Icons
12. Typography and language
13. Wallpaper and Wallpaper Studio
14. Immersive Mode
15. Nexus Island
16. Notifications and badges
17. App Lock
18. Search
19. News feed and Library
20. Backup, restore and sharing
21. Settings map
22. Privacy, feedback and diagnostics
23. Troubleshooting
24. Glossary and setup checklist

CHAPTER 1

Getting started

Nexus Launcher replaces your phone's home screen. It keeps the things you expect — a grid of apps, a dock, folders, widgets — and adds a drawer with three layouts, a customizable status row, an optional live pill called Nexus Island, and a design tool for building your own home screen pieces.

First launch

On a new install Nexus shows a short, skippable setup sequence. Every card has **Skip**, and your place is remembered — if Android restarts the launcher when you change the default Home app, setup resumes where you left off.

1. **Welcome to Nexus.** Pick how to start: **Start fresh** (clean defaults), **Import from Nova Launcher**, or **Restore a Nexus backup**. The last two finish setup and take you straight to Backup & Restore.
2. **Theme.** Light, dark, or follow your phone.
3. **UI Style.** How widgets, folders and the dock look. Try each one — the choice is applied immediately.
4. **Wallpaper.** Choose a Nexus-made wallpaper or open Wallpaper Studio.
5. **Feed page.** Swipe right on the home screen to reach your news feed. You can turn this off here or later in Home Screen settings.
6. **Permissions.** Allow only what you want to use. Each row reads **Allow** until granted, then ✓ **Granted**.
7. **Default Home App.** Tap **Set Default** so the Home button and home gesture open Nexus.

> **Tip**
>
> You can skip every step and still change all of it later. Nothing in setup is permanent.

What each permission unlocks

Nexus asks for nothing at install time. These are granted individually, and every one can be reviewed later in **Settings › Notifications & Permissions › System & Permissions**.

Permission	What it enables	Without it
Notification Access	Badge counts, the in-launcher notification sheet, the Music widget	No badges; the sheet sends you to system settings
Storage & Media Access	Blur behind third-party wallpapers on Android 12 and below	Frosted surfaces look flat
Accessibility Service	Global gesture actions such as Lock Screen, and Strict Lock Mode	Those specific actions are unavailable
App Usage Access	Recent apps in the drawer and search, and usage rings on star pages	Recent apps sections stay empty
Location Access	Weather widget, weather status item, Wi-Fi network name	Weather asks for location when opened
Contacts Access	Contact results in search	Search returns apps only
Nearby devices	Connected Bluetooth device in Nexus Island and the status row	That Island event is skipped

> **Android 13 and later**
>
> Storage & Media is only requested on Android 12 and below. On newer versions Nexus uses the system photo picker, which needs no permission.

Setting Nexus as your default launcher

If you skipped the last setup card, open **Settings › Home Screen** and use the default-launcher banner at the top, or go through Android's own **Settings › Apps › Default apps › Home app**.

CHAPTER 2

The home screen

Everything on the home screen lives on a grid. Apps, folders, shortcuts and widgets all snap to it, and every control that changes the grid is in **Settings › Home Screen**.

Grid Layout

Setting	Range or options	Default	Notes
Columns	4–12	6	On a tablet or unfolded foldable this edits the large-screen grid, used in both orientations.
Rows	5–15	10	Same large-screen behavior as Columns.
Icon Size	40–100%	65%	Scales icons inside their cell. Labels are unaffected.
App Label	On / Off	On	Turns app names off and on.
Two-line labels	On / Off	Off	Wraps long names onto a second line. Dimmed while App Label is off.
Page Indicator	On / Off	On	The dots above the dock.
Show Dock	On / Off	On	When off, the grid uses the dock's space. Your dock apps are kept.

> **Columns, Rows and Icon Size are staged**
>
> These three wait for the **Apply** bar at the bottom of the page. Everything else on the page takes effect immediately. Leaving the page with pending changes asks whether to discard them.

Screen Spacing

Four sliders let you tighten or loosen the layout. Negative values pull the grid past the screen edge or pull rows together; icons shrink to fit rather than overlap.

Setting	Range	Default	Effect
Padding Horizontal	−4 to 64 dp	0 dp	Left and right screen margin
Padding Vertical	−32 to 64 dp	0 dp	Top and bottom screen margin
Gap Horizontal	0 to 64 dp	0 dp	Space between icons in a row
Gap Vertical	0 to 64 dp	0 dp	Space between rows

Transitions

The **Page Transition** row chooses how one page becomes the next: **None**, **Slide** (default), **Fade**, **Cube**, **Zoom**, **Flip** and **Gravity Fold**.

- **Reduce Motion** — minimizes launcher animations. Moving transitions become a fade, and bounce and overshoot are removed across the app.
- **Transition Speed** — 50–200%, default 100%. Higher values make the animation take longer.
- **Swipe right to access RSS feed** — shows the news feed on the leftmost screen. On by default.

> **If you prefer stillness**
>
> Turn on Reduce Motion, then pick **Fade** or **None** as the page transition. Cube, Flip, Zoom and Gravity Fold are the most animated options.

Adding things to the home screen

There are four ways to put something on the grid:

1. **From the drawer.** Long-press an app and drag it up, or use the drawer's selection bar and choose **Pin**.
2. **Long-press empty space.** The radial menu offers **Apps**, **Widgets**, **Folder** and **Shortcut**.
3. **Widget picker.** Tap a widget to drop it at the centre of the page, or drag it to an exact spot.
4. **Widgets from an app's menu.** Long-press an app that provides widgets; a **Widgets** row appears only when the app actually has some.

Working with icons

Long-press a home-screen icon to open its menu:

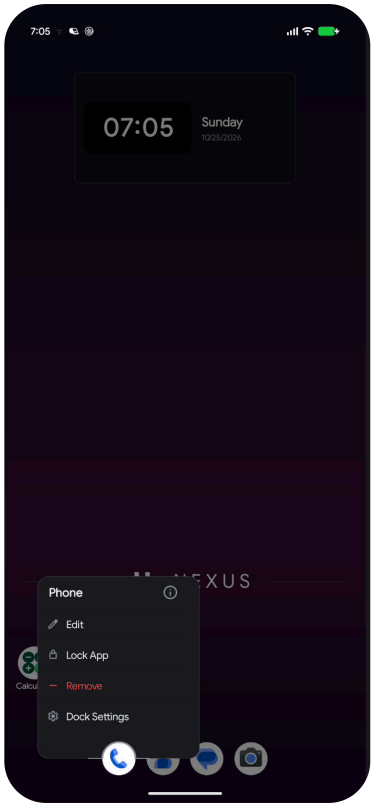
- **Select** — starts multi-select (see below).
- **Edit** — rename the app, choose a custom icon, change its shape, and set per-app gestures.
- **Lock App** / **Unlock App** — protects the app with your fingerprint, face or screen lock.
- **Resize** — lets the icon span more than one cell. Apps only; not offered in the dock.
- **Remove** — takes this copy off the home screen. The app stays installed and stays in the drawer.

> **Duplicates are independent**
>
> The same app can appear several times. Removing one copy removes only that copy — never the others.

Multi-select

Choose **Select** from any icon menu, then tap more icons to add them. A ring appears around each selection and a bar shows how many you have picked, for example **"3 selected"**.

- **Home screen: Remove**, **Create Folder** (two or more apps), and **Uninstall** (one app at a time).
- **Drawer: Pin** to place the selection on the home screen, **Hide App**, and **Create Folder**.
- The home screen zooms out slightly while selecting so the bar never covers icons.
- Only the **X** button leaves selection mode. Tapping empty space does nothing, and the drawer still scrolls normally.



The icon menu keeps the pressed icon bright while everything else dims.

CHAPTER 3

Pages and the home layout

You can have as many home pages as you like. Swipe left and right to move between them; the dots above the dock show where you are.

Manage Pages

Open it from the radial menu: long-press empty space, then choose **Pages**. The screen shows a two-column grid of phone-shaped page cards.

- The header counts your pages and names the Home one, for example **"3 pages · Home is 1"**.
- Each card shows a live thumbnail of that page, including its widgets.
- The default page carries a **Home** badge.
- **Set a page as Home** with the home chip on its card. The Home button, the home gesture and closing all apps return to that page.
- **Reorder** by long-pressing a card and dragging it.
- **Delete** with the delete chip. An empty page goes immediately; a page with items asks first and names the count. The last remaining page cannot be deleted.
- **Add a page** with the dashed **Add Page** card.

> **Pages follow their contents**
>
> Reordering pages moves each page's own settings with it, and deleting a page cleans up anything that belonged only to that page. Your Home page setting is adjusted automatically so it never points at a page that no longer exists.

The radial menu

Long-pressing empty home space opens an eight-slice radial menu at your finger. It tracks your finger without lifting, so you can slide straight onto an option; move far enough away and the menu cancels.

Slice	What it does
Apps	Pick apps to place on the grid
Widgets	Open the widget picker
Wallpaper	Open the wallpaper sheet
Pages	Open Manage Pages
Folder	Create an empty folder at that spot
Shortcut	Add a shortcut
Settings	Fan out ten shortcuts: Home, Drawer, Dock, Theme, Icons, Typography, Gestures, Search, Notifications, Backup
Lock Layout	Changes the slice label to a locked state

Moving things around

- **Within a page:** long-press and drag. The target cells highlight, and the icon drops into the cell under its centre.
- **Across pages:** hold an icon near the left or right edge of the screen and the launcher turns the page for you.
- **Into the dock:** drag all the way down; the drop only commits when your finger is genuinely over the dock.
- **Onto another icon:** creates a folder from both apps. A red highlight means the drop will be refused.
- **Rotation and grid changes:** icons keep their physical place on screen instead of clustering in a corner. If a smaller grid has no room, items spill to the next free cell or page rather than disappearing.

CHAPTER 4

Gestures

Nexus has three kinds of gesture: swipes on empty home space, swipes on an individual icon or folder, and swipes inside the drawer. All of them are configurable.

Home screen swipes

Find these in **Settings › Gestures**.

Gesture	Default action	Notes
Swipe Up	Open App Drawer	Only starts on empty home space with the drawer closed
Swipe Down	Open Search	Same
Two-Finger Swipe Up	None	Optional
Two-Finger Swipe Down	None	Optional

Actions you can assign

The action picker groups its options as **Navigation**, **System**, **Launcher** and **Shortcuts**.

- None
- Open App Info
- Lock Screen
- Toggle Flashlight
- Open App Drawer
- Open Specific App
- Open Specific Page
- Open Specific Folder
- Open Specific Shortcut
- Expand Notifications
- Open Quick Settings
- Show Recents
- Take Screenshot
- Show Power Menu
- Open Search
- Next Page
- Previous Page
- Toggle Labels
- Home Edit Mode
- Split Screen

> **Lock Screen needs Accessibility**
>
> The picker marks it "Requires accessibility". Enable the service in **Settings › Notifications & Permissions** first, or the action will not fire.

Gestures on a single app or folder

Long-press an icon → **Edit**. The **Gestures** section offers **Swipe Up**, **Swipe Down** and **Double Tap**. This is how you launch one particular app or shortcut without opening the app first — for example swipe up on your camera icon to open the gallery.

Drawer and page swipes

- **Swipe up** on the home screen opens the drawer; **swipe down** inside the drawer closes it. A fast flick completes the motion, and the midpoint decides when you let go slowly.
- **Swipe left or right** to change home pages. The page follows your finger.
- **Swipe right from the first page** opens the news feed, if it is enabled.
- **Swiping over a widget** still pages the home screen; a scrollable list inside a widget scrolls first, and pages the home screen once it reaches its end.

CHAPTER 5

The app drawer

Swipe up on the home screen. The drawer has three completely different modes, and each one has its own layout controls.

Choosing a drawer mode

Go to **Settings › App Drawer › Layout**, or open the drawer's overflow menu (the three lines beside the search pill) and use its **Layout** row.

Mode	What it looks like	Extra layout option
Grid	Classic columns of icons with labels	2–10 columns
List	One or two wide columns; can group apps under letter headings	1–2 columns (up to 4 on a large screen)
Categories	Apps organised into category cards	**Spatial**, **Strip** or **List**

Category layouts. **Spatial** shows a hero card with peeking side cards. **Strip** is a horizontal row of category cards with a **See all** link on each. **List** stacks categories with a letter rail like the Grid mode.

Layout settings

- **Columns** — as above. Dimmed in Categories mode.
- **Group by letter** — only in List mode with A–Z sorting. Adds letter headings between apps.
- **Icon Size** — 40–85%, default 65%.
- **App Label** and **Two-line labels** — the drawer has its own label settings, independent of the home screen.
- **Sort Order** — **A–Z**, **Z–A** or **Recently Installed**. The A–Z rail hides itself for non-alphabetical sorts.
- **Transition** — **Default**, **3D Cube**, **Zoom**, **Tilt** or **Card Stack**.

Search and navigation

Setting	Options	Default
Search Pill	On / Off	On
Search Pill Position	Top / Bottom	Top
Categories	On / Off	On
Category Style	In Pill / Dropdown / Strip	In Pill
Category Bar Position	Top / Bottom	Top
Side Rail	On / Off	On
Show recent apps	On / Off	Follows drawer mode

Getting around the drawer

- **A–Z rail.** Drag along the right edge and the drawer scrubs through the alphabet, with a bubble showing the current letter and a tick for each one. Letters with no apps are dimmed.
- **Category bar.** Tap a chip to filter. The chip menu also offers **New category**, **Edit categories** and **Sort apps**; inside edit mode, tapping an icon or name changes it, and **Restore default categories** undoes your edits.
- **Recent apps.** A section at the top of the drawer showing what you used lately. It needs App Usage Access; without it the drawer offers **Tap to enable Recent Apps**.
- **Overflow menu.** Hidden Apps, Create Folder, Drawer Settings, plus inline rows for Layout, Columns, Style, Sort Order, Group by letter, Recent apps and the bar position.

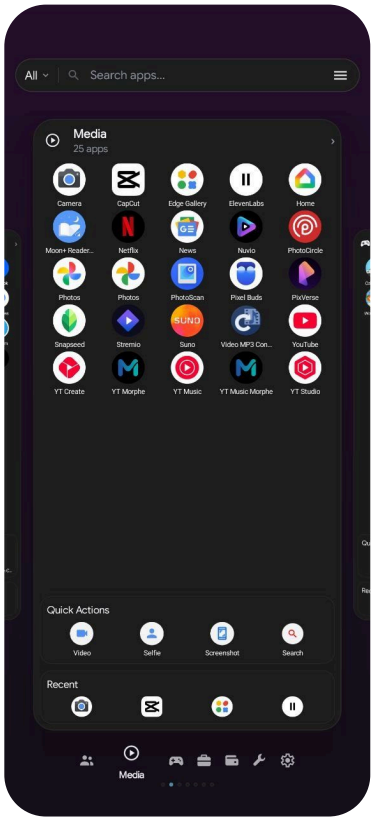
Hiding apps

Long-press an app in the drawer and choose **Hide App**, or select several and use the selection bar. Hidden apps are listed in **Settings › App Drawer › Hidden Apps**, where each one has an **Unhide** button.

> **Hiding is not locking**
>
> A hidden app is out of sight, not protected. To require authentication before an app opens, use App Lock.

Drawer folders

Create one from the overflow menu (**Create Folder**, titled **New Folder**) or by selecting two or more apps and choosing **Create Folder**. Drawer folders appear at the top of the drawer and open the same way home folders do.



Categories mode: the search pill, the category carousel, and quick actions and recents for the selected category.

CHAPTER 6

Folders

Folders work on the home screen, in the dock and in the drawer. Opening one shows a floating card anchored to the folder icon rather than a full screen, so you never lose sight of where you came from.

Creating and filling a folder

- **Merge two apps:** drag one icon onto another.
- **Merge a selection:** multi-select two or more apps, then **Create Folder**.
- **Start empty:** radial menu → **Folder**.
- **Add apps later:** drag an app onto the folder icon, or open the folder and use its **Add** button.

> **No duplicates inside a folder**
>
> Dropping an app into a folder that already contains it is refused, with an explanation. This keeps folders predictable when you are reorganising in a hurry.

Inside an open folder

- **Tap** an app to launch it.
- **Long-press** an app for **Remove from Folder**, its shortcuts, **App Info** and **Uninstall**.
- **Reorder:** long-press an icon and drag; the surrounding icons slide aside to show where it will land.
- **Sort:** tap the **Sort** button to arrange the folder alphabetically. The new order is saved immediately.
- **Drag out:** pull an icon past the edge of the folder card and it is handed to the home screen, where you can drop it anywhere.
- **Close:** tap outside the card, or press Back.

Editing a folder

Open the folder and tap **Edit**. The sheet groups its controls into **Appearance**, **Layout** and **Gestures**.

Section	Controls
Name	The folder name, edited inline
Preview Style	**Grid**, **Fan of 3**, **Hero + Orbit**, **Custom Icon**, **Bento** — how the closed folder icon looks
Appearance	Window and icon opacity, glass refraction, expressive gradient
Layout	Columns inside the open folder, and **Show App Labels**
Gestures	Swipe Up, Swipe Down and Double Tap on the folder icon

> **Two opacities, on purpose**
>
> **Icon Opacity** affects the closed folder icon on the home screen. **Window Opacity** affects the card you see when the folder is open. They are independent, so a subtle icon can still open into a solid card.

Folder settings that travel

- If you drag a folder into the dock, its appearance and contents come with it.
- Deleting a folder deletes the folder and its contents together; you are asked first and told how many apps are inside.
- Backups include folder covers and the apps inside, and restore them in the correct order.

CHAPTER 7

The dock

The dock is the strip of apps at the bottom of the home screen. It holds apps and folders, and it scrolls when you put more items in it than the maximum you have set.

Opening Dock Settings

Three routes, all leading to the same sheet:

- **Settings › Dock**
- Long-press an empty part of the dock
- Long-press a dock icon and choose **Dock Settings**

Layout & sizing

Setting	Range	Default
Max Icons	1–10	4
Icon Size	32–72 dp	48 dp
Height	60–120 dp	90 dp
Corner Radius	0–40 dp	20 dp

Background

- **Background swatches** — none, fifteen gradients, or a solid colour.
- **Opacity** — 0–100%, default 80%. In Liquid Glass this row is labelled **Liquid clarity**.
- **Glass Refraction** — 0–100%, default 70%. Labelled **Refraction amount** in Liquid Glass.
- **Liquid Glass extras** — **Liquid blur**, **Refraction height** (8–48 dp) and **Chromatic aberration**.
- **Expressive Gradient** — turns a frosted gradient background on or off.

Labels & search

- **Show Labels** — off by default.
- **Font Size** — 8–16 sp, only visible when labels are on.
- **Show Search** — adds a search control to the dock.

> **Saving your dock**
>
> Dock Settings uses **Reset** and **Apply**. Closing with unsaved changes asks before discarding, and Reset offers to restore the default dock apps as well as the default appearance.

Using the dock

- Tap an app to launch it; tap a folder to open it.
- Long-press an app for **Edit**, **Lock App**, **Remove** and **Dock Settings**. Dock menus do not offer Resize or Select.
- If the dock holds more items than **Max Icons**, swipe sideways inside it to reach the rest; a small indicator shows the dock's pages.
- In landscape the dock becomes a strip along one side, and the grid makes room for it.

> **Need more grid room?**
>
> Turn off **Show Dock** in Home Screen settings and the grid expands into that space. Your dock apps are kept, so turning it back on restores them.

CHAPTER 8

Widgets

Nexus hosts Android widgets like any launcher, and adds its own set that are drawn to match the theme. The picker has two tabs: **Nexus** for the built-in widgets and **All** for everything installed on your phone.

Placing a widget

1. Long-press empty home space and choose **Widgets**.
2. Search with **Search widgets…**, or browse a tab.
3. Tap a widget to drop it in the middle of the page, or long-press and drag it to the exact spot you want.

> **Limits**
>
> A page has a maximum number of widgets and will say so. Invalid drops are refused with **Drop not allowed** rather than placed somewhere unexpected.

Nexus widgets

Widget	Size	What it does
Living Mosaic	3×3	A container of several widgets with pages and a focus mode
Shortcut Box	2×2	A grid of shortcut buttons, including Nexus actions
App Box	2×2	A tidy grid of apps inside a card
Recent apps	3×3	Your most recently used apps, newest first
Music	100×80 dp	Playback controls and the current track
Weather	100×80 dp	Current conditions and forecast
Calendar	100×80 dp	Month grid and week strip
Clock	100×80 dp	Time, date and temperature
Glance	180×90 dp	Clock, date and weather in one block
Agenda	140×110 dp	Your next events as a schedule
Notes	140×110 dp	A scratchpad with urgency, status and progress
Battery	100×80 dp	Charge level and power details
Device Performance	180×110 dp	CPU, memory, storage and temperature
Search	350×56 dp	A search bar; resizes horizontally only

The Progress Bar widget is present in the app but withheld from the picker in this release, so you will not see it.

Moving, resizing and replacing

Long-press a placed widget for its menu:

- **Move** — drag it, or use the arrow pills for precise nudges.
- **Resize** — eight handles, with snapping and a tick at each cell boundary. You can also nudge one edge at a time.
- **Elevation** — controls which widget sits in front when two overlap. Shown as **Z: 2**.
- **Replace** — pick a different widget; the old one is only removed once the new one is placed.
- **Padding** — hosted widgets only. Adds breathing room inside the card.
- **Settings** — the widget's own options.
- **Remove**.

> **Keep your bearings while editing**
>
> Long-pressing a widget does not blur the workspace. Neighbouring widgets, folders and icons stay sharp so you can size one against the others; only the menu panel itself is frosted.

Widget appearance

Most Nexus widgets share two options in their settings sheet:

- **Widget Theme** — **Follow** the launcher theme, or pin **Light** / **Dark** for that one widget.
- **Widget UI** — **Soft UI**, **Glass** or **Solid**.

Living Mosaic

A Mosaic is a small window onto several widgets at once. Add one, then drag widgets into it or use **Add Widget** from its menu.

- **Pages.** A Mosaic can hold multiple pages of widgets; swipe to change page.
- **Mosaic mode** shows the whole page and reflows as you swipe. **Focus mode** shows one widget at a time in a fixed-size carousel.
- **Mosaic Studio** (from **Settings** in the Mosaic menu) offers Opacity, Glass Refraction, Mosaic Shape (Squircle or Square), Expressive Mode, eight layout templates, page add/remove, and the default mode.
- **Scrollable children still scroll.** Swiping on a list inside a Mosaic scrolls the list first; once it reaches the end, the swipe changes Mosaic page.
- A Mosaic holds up to twelve widgets per page.

Shortcut Box, App Box and Recent apps

- **Shortcut Box** — tap an empty well to choose a shortcut. Eight Nexus shortcuts are built in: App drawer, Bluetooth, Flashlight, Dark theme, Do Not Disturb, Wi-Fi, Volume panel and System settings. Long-press a filled slot to change or remove it.
- **App Box** — tap an empty well to choose an app; labels can be turned on or off.
- **Recent apps** — fills itself from App Usage Access. Apps you uninstall drop out on their own.
- All three share the same sizing options: icon spacing (**Tight**, **Normal**, **Wide**) and a widget theme.

Widget permissions

A few widgets need data you must allow first. Weather asks for location; Calendar and Agenda ask for calendar access; Music needs Notification Access to read the current track. Each widget shows a clear prompt instead of failing silently.



The picker's Nexus tab; tap to place at the centre, or drag to position precisely.

CHAPTER 9

Nexus Canvas

Canvas is a design board you place on a home page like a widget. Instead of arranging icons in cells, you compose a rectangle out of pieces — large type, a clock, the weather, a music player, app strips, folders, photos, shapes and stickers — and position each piece exactly where you want it.

> **Where it lives**
>
> **Settings** › **Canvas**. Saved designs appear in the Canvas Library; **+** creates a new one.

Creating a design

1. Tap **+** in the Canvas Library.
2. Choose a footprint: **Edge to Edge** (the whole screen, with guides for the cutout and dock) or **Custom Grid** (a rectangle inside the normal workspace, minimum 3×3 cells, up to your current grid size).
3. Tap **Create Canvas**. The new design is called **Untitled Canvas** until you rename it.

Canvas Studio

The editing screen has four actions along the top:

Action	What it does
Layers	Reorder or delete layers; tap a layer for its own actions
Style	Theme, UI style, glass tuning, icon pack, labels and tile spacing
Save	Saves the design without placing it
Apply	Saves and places the design on the home screen

Undo and **Redo** sit at the bottom left. Tap the title to rename the design.

What you can add

The add menu holds ten entries:

- **Templates**
- **Add Component**
- **Add App**
- **Add Icon Strip**
- **Add Folder**
- **Add Shortcut**
- **Shortcut strip**
- **Image**
- **Add Widget**
- **Background**

Studio Components are grouped by category: All, Shapes, Clocks, Weather, Music, Battery, Dialer, Keyboard, Stickers, Text and Icons. Some are interactive rather than decorative — the dialers and keyboards are working keypads, and there is a working calculator.

Text objects can use live values, so a heading can show the time, date, day, battery level, weather or city, and update on its own. They also support size, weight, alignment, letter spacing, colour, rotation and curved shapes such as an arch or a wave.

Templates

Templates give you a finished starting point instead of a blank board. They are grouped as Minimal, Neumorphic, Windows and Additional, and include pieces such as **Minimal Mono**, **Glass Fog**, **Neumorphic Cream**, **Retro Windows**, **Windows 98 Taskbar** and **Pocket Calculator**.

Background

- **Solid Color** — a swatch and an opacity, with Reset.
- **Nexus Wallpaper** — the same nine built-in presets as the wallpaper sheet.
- **Gallery Image** — your own photo, fitted with Fill or Show whole image, and a position slider.
- In glass styles the Canvas is see-through, so a colour tints the glass rather than covering it.

Placing and editing a Canvas

- **Apply** places the design and confirms with **"Canvas applied to Home Screen."**
- If the page is full, Nexus offers to create a new page and place it there; the design is saved either way.
- To change a placed Canvas, long-press it and choose **Canvas Settings**.
- Long-press a Canvas card in the library for **Duplicate**, **Rename** and **Delete**.

CHAPTER 10

Theme and appearance

Settings › Theme holds five cards: Theme, UI Style, Background, Accent Color and Color Accessibility. Everything here applies immediately — there is no Apply button on this page.

Theme mode

Five options in one row:

- **Automatic** — follows your phone's light or dark setting.
- **Light** and **Dark** — fixed.
- **AMOLED** — true black backgrounds, for OLED screens.
- **Calm** — a low-stimulus mode with its own palettes.

When Calm is selected, a **Calm Palette** row appears with sixteen choices: Rich Sand, Golden Sand, Ocean Blue (default), Navy Ink, Deep Navy, Ember Red, Forest Green, Amber Dusk, Burnt Orange, Deep Plum, Slate Grey, Aurora, Dusk Rose, Tidepool, Copper Night and Sunset Ink.

UI Style

Four styles change how surfaces are drawn across the launcher:

Style	Look
Default	Flat, solid surfaces
Frosted Glass	Blurred acrylic that samples your wallpaper
Neumorphism	Soft raised plates with real shadows
Liquid Glass	Refraction and light-bending glass on widgets, folders and the dock

Liquid Glass adds three controls of its own:

- **Theme color tint** — gives widgets, folders and the dock a light touch of your theme colour.
- **Tint strength** — 25–200%, default 100%. Hidden while the tint is off.
- A scope note explaining that Liquid Glass applies to widgets, folders and the dock, while pages, sheets and search stay frosted.

> **Frost needs a wallpaper capture**
>
> If you set your wallpaper from outside Nexus — another app, or a live wallpaper — the glass styles need one capture of it before they can blur it. Use **Capture wallpaper for frost/liquid glass** on the Theme page, or the same row in the wallpaper sheet's System tab. Until then, frosted surfaces look flat.

Background

- **Background Layer** — **Wallpaper** or **Theme Color**. Theme Color replaces the wallpaper with a flat theme colour everywhere, including behind frost.

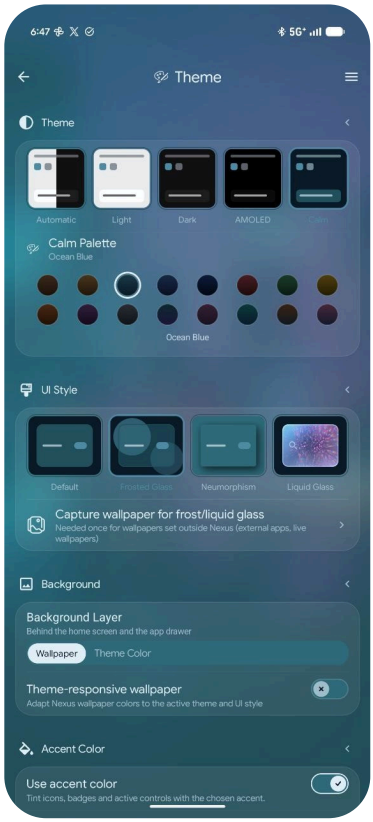
- **Theme-responsive wallpaper** — adapts Nexus-made wallpaper colours to the active theme and UI style. It works only with wallpapers applied through Nexus Studio, and the app says so when you turn it on.

Accent Color

- **Use accent color** — on by default. Turning it off hides the swatches and leaves controls neutral.
- **Accent in icon badges** — off by default. Tints settings and status-row icon badges with the accent.
- Eight presets — Harbor (default), Mist, Sage, Clay, Sand, Rose, Lilac and Slate — plus a custom swatch that opens a full colour picker. A custom colour is labelled **Custom · #RRGGBB**.

Color Accessibility (Beta)

Three options: **Off**, **Red-Green** and **Blue-Yellow**. This adjusts accents for colour vision deficiencies; it changes accent colours only, not the whole palette.



Theme settings: mode, palette, UI style, background and accent in one scroll.

CHAPTER 11

Icons

Settings › **Icons** controls icon size, shape and pack for the whole launcher, with a live preview at the top of the page.

Icon size

Icon Size sets one global size from 32 to 72 dp, default 48 dp, used by the home screen, drawer, dock and folders. Any surface that has its own size set keeps that instead.

Shape

Fourteen shapes are available:

- System
- Circle
- Squircle
- Rounded
- Square
- Pill
- Hex
- Soft Hex
- Octagon
- Diamond
- Pebble
- Teardrop
- Leaf
- Badge

System keeps each app's own mask, so different apps can look different.

Icon pack

- The first tile is always **System Default**, followed by every icon pack installed on your phone.
- Selecting a pack applies it immediately to the home screen, drawer and dock.
- If you had changed some icons one by one, Nexus asks **"Use the new icon pack everywhere?"** — choose **Keep them** to preserve those individual icons, or **Switch them** to bring them into the pack. Icons made from your own photos always stay as they are.
- There is no in-app store: Nexus uses packs you have installed from elsewhere.

Themed Icons (Beta)

Themed Icons tints icons to match your theme colours. It and a third-party icon pack are mutually exclusive: turning Themed Icons on returns the pack to System Default, and choosing a pack turns Themed Icons off. Nexus tells you which happened.

Changing a single app

1. Long-press the app and choose **Edit**.
2. Tap the name to rename it, or pick a new icon from **Gallery** or **Icon packs**.
3. In the shape carousel, **Global** means "follow the Theme shape"; any other tile overrides the shape for this app only.
4. Apply, or use Reset to return to the system icon, name and shape.

Leaving with unsaved edits

If you change something and try to close the Edit sheet, Nexus asks first instead of quietly dropping your work.

CHAPTER 12

Typography and language

Settings › **Typography** changes the font used across the launcher and the language the app speaks, independently of your phone's language.

The preview

A specimen line reads **Aa Bb Gg Qq 0123456789** so every typeface can be compared on the same letters, with a sentence in the selected language underneath and an **LTR** or **RTL** badge.

Font Family

Fourteen fonts ship with the app:

Font	Character
Nexus Default	Nexus brand typeface (Google Sans Flex)
System Default	Your device's font
Sans, Serif, Mono, Medium	The classic Android families
Roboto	Classic Android geometric
Inter	Modern grotesque sans
Manrope	Contemporary geometric sans
IBM Plex Sans	Engineered grotesque sans
Lora	Contemporary serif
Playpen	Casual handwriting
Elms Sans	Expressive grotesque
Bitcount	Single-line retro pixel font

Choosing a font applies it immediately, everywhere: settings, sheets, dialogs, context menus, the drawer, and the text inside Nexus widgets.

Custom Fonts

Use **+ Add Font** to import a `.ttf` or `.otf` file. Imported fonts appear in the font list and can be deleted later; deleting asks first. A file that is not a valid font is rejected with a message rather than applied.

Language

Eleven choices: System default, English, Spanish, Portuguese (Brazil), Hindi, Indonesian, German, French, Nepali, Arabic and Hebrew. The sheet shows each language in its own script. Changing language reloads Settings so the new strings appear immediately.

> **Arabic and Hebrew**
>
> Text and navigation mirror to right-to-left, but your home screen layout does not. Icons, widgets and pages keep their exact positions — a deliberate choice, so switching language never rearranges your work.

CHAPTER 13

Wallpaper and Wallpaper Studio

> **Where to find it**
>
> Long-press empty home space and choose **Wallpaper**. The wallpaper sheet is not in Settings; the Theme page links to it for the frost capture step.

The five tabs

Tab	Contents
System	Your current wallpaper, plus the one-time frost capture and a Clear button
Nexus	Nine designed presets and twenty-four gradients
Studio	Wallpaper Studio: Quick Create, Custom Wallpaper, Edit Current setup
Gallery	Your six most recent images, then More / Choose photo
Others	Other wallpaper apps installed on your phone

Nexus presets

Nine wallpapers are designed for the glass styles: Obsidian Stealth, Nexus Core, Frost Aurora, Prism Beam, Liquid Quartz, Cyber Horizon, Monolith, Frosted Capsule and Titanium Grid. The light fields in Frost Aurora, Prism Beam and Liquid Quartz are tuned to show refraction in frosted widgets and folders.

Twenty-four gradients sit in a second carousel, from Winter Woods and Peach Sea to Crimson Tide, Kashmir and Blue and Orange.

Dim and tint

Above the tabs are a live preview and two sliders, **Dim** and **Strength**, with a colour wheel. Use them to darken a bright photo or wash it with a colour. The treatment is previewed live before you apply it.

Applying

Apply asks where the wallpaper should go: **Home Screen**, **Lock Screen** or **Both**. Choosing Both sets the lock screen first, so a failure there cannot leave the home screen half-changed. Nexus-made and gallery wallpapers are also written to Android's own wallpaper slot, so the recents screen and system settings show the same image.

Wallpaper Studio

Studio is a design tool for launcher-aware wallpapers. It can start from your current home layout as a reference layer, or from a blank canvas, and offers:

- **Shapes** — rectangle, rounded rectangle, circle, line, polygon and blob, placed by touch.
- **Images** — your own pictures with non-destructive brightness, contrast, saturation, tint and opacity.

- **Snapping** — to cell centres, screen centre and widget bounds.
- **Create Backdrop** — generates a backdrop underneath selected widgets and folders.
- **Undo and redo**, plus Wallpaper Only, Home Preview and Grid Preview modes.
- **Save and apply**, which also syncs the result to the system wallpaper.

Projects are saved so you can reopen and adjust them later.

CHAPTER 14

Immersive Mode

Immersive Mode hides Android's system bars and replaces the status bar with one Nexus draws itself. You can shape that row into almost anything, from a single minimal clock to a full row of pills with signal, battery and notifications.

Find it in **Settings** › **Immersive Mode**. A live preview is pinned above the settings and updates as you change things.

Turning it on

- **Immersive Mode** — hides the system bars. Swipe from an edge to bring them back temporarily.
- **Hide navigation bar** — appears only while Immersive is on. Off keeps the buttons or gesture bar on screen.

Row presets

Four starting points: **Minimal**, **Glass**, **Ring** and **Classic**. A preset changes appearance only — never which items are shown, the clock style or the font.

Bar Layout

Setting	Options	Default
Nexus Status Bar	On / Off	On
Position	Top / Bottom	Top
Height	24–48 dp	28 dp
Background	Transparent / Frosted / Solid	Frosted
Opacity	10–90%	40%
Faded background	On / Off	Off
Segmented pills	On / Off	On
Side padding	0–24 dp	0 dp
Font	Follow launcher, or a specific font	Follow launcher

Segmented pills gives each module its own capsule; turning it off draws one continuous bar. **Faded background** softens the bar's edge into the wallpaper.

What to display

Six items, all on by default. Each has its own style options:

Item	Styles	Extra options
Clock	Default, 12-hour, 24-hour, Seconds, With date	Position: Left, Centre, Right. With date adds Date: Short, Long, Weekday
Notifications	Count, App icons, Dot	Icons shown 1–10, count silent notifications, count apps instead of notifications
Battery	Bar, Capsule, Segmented, Ring, Number only	Percentage: Beside, Inside, Off. Low battery below 5–30%; shimmer while charging
Mobile signal	Bars, Arc, Dots	Show carrier name, show band
Wi-Fi	Arcs, Bars, Dots	—
System icons	Do Not Disturb, alarm, silent and more	On / Off

Using the row

- **Pull down** on the row to open the launcher's notification sheet.
- **Tap the notification icons or count** to open the same sheet.
- **Tap the clock** to open your alarm app; the battery area opens battery settings.
- **Swipe from the screen edge** to reveal the real system bars when you need them.

> **Start with a preset**
>
> Pick Glass or Ring, then adjust only the items you care about. Changing a preset later keeps your item choices intact, so experimenting is safe.

CHAPTER 15

Nexus Island

Nexus Island is an optional morphing pill that sits over your camera cutout. When something happens — a download finishes, a track changes, the battery gets low — it expands briefly to show you, then collapses back to a small capsule.

> **It needs Immersive Mode**
>
> The Island lives inside Nexus's own status row, which only appears in Immersive Mode. If Immersive is off, the Island page shows a single row reading **"Needs Immersive mode"**; tapping it takes you there.

Settings

Setting	Range or options	Default
Enable Nexus Island	On / Off	Off
Size and Position	Opens the calibration sheet; the row shows the current size	110 × 28 dp
Animation speed	50–150%	100%
Capsule Haptics	On / Off	On

Calibrating it

Every phone puts its cutout in a different place, so the Island can be moved and resized to sit exactly over it. Open **Size and Position**:

- **Horizontal Offset** — −100 to 100, with a **Center** button.
- **Vertical Offset** — −25 to 35, with an **Align** button.
- **Capsule Width** — 50–260 dp, default 110.
- **Capsule Height** — 20–44 dp, default 28.

The sheet's guide text explains the goal: align the capsule directly over the cutout, and the status row automatically pushes its information to the sides so nothing overlaps.

Mini Capsule Events

Nine triggers, each individually switchable and all on by default:

- Live activities — downloads, navigation, rides and other apps showing live progress
- Music
- Charging
- Low battery
- Bluetooth
- Timer
- Stopwatch
- Do Not Disturb
- Calendar

If the Nearby devices permission is missing, the Bluetooth row says so and links to the fix.

CHAPTER 16

Notifications and badges

Nexus can show unread counts on your icons and give you a notification panel of its own, drawn in the launcher instead of Android's. Both depend on one permission: Notification Access.

Badges

Find them in **Settings › Notifications & Permissions › Notification Badges**.

Setting	Options	Default	Notes
App Icon Badges	Off / Dot / Count	Dot	Dot is a small dot; Count is a numbered pill, capped at 99+
Folder Badges	Off / Dot / Count	Dot	Totals every app inside the folder
Notification Badge Color	Red (default), Green, Blue, or custom	Red	Tap the circle to pick any colour

Badges appear on home screen icons, dock icons and drawer icons, and update in real time.

Notification history

- **Keep notifications** — off by default. When on, notifications you have already cleared are still readable in Nexus's own sheet. The text is stored on this phone.
- **Keep for** — 1 hour, 6 hours, 1 day, 3 days or 7 days.

System & Permissions

The page lists every permission with a counter such as **"4 of 8 permissions granted"** and a status of **Granted**, **Tap to enable** or **Enabled**. Each row explains what it unlocks, so you can grant only what you need. See Chapter 1 for the full list.

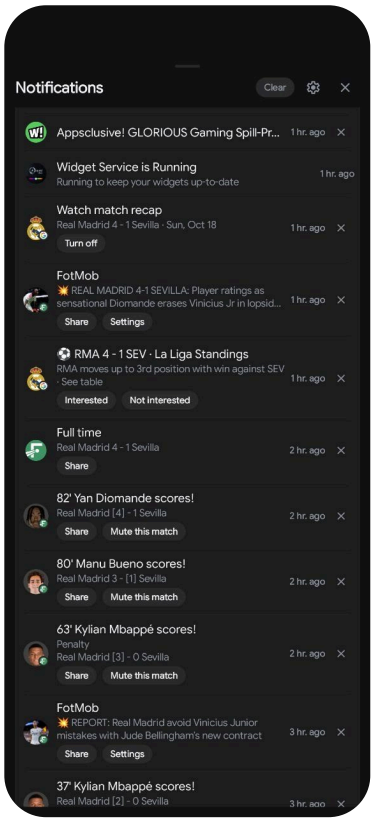
The notification sheet

Open it by pulling down on the immersive status row, tapping its notification icons, or from a gesture you have assigned.

- **Swipe a notification sideways** to dismiss it; ongoing notifications resist and spring back.
- **Tap** a notification to open it. Up to three action buttons appear inline, such as Reply or Mark as read.
- **Tap body text** to expand a long message.
- **Clear** dismisses everything and wipes the stored history.
- **The gear** opens in-sheet Notification Settings: keep notifications, retention, Clear History, Group by App, Show Silent Notifications, Notification Listener Access, and Status Bar Appearance.
- Notifications are grouped as **Now** and **Earlier**; when there are none, the sheet shows **"All Caught Up"**.

Without Notification Access

The sheet explains the permission and offers to open the system setting. Badges and the Music widget stay inactive until it is granted.



The in-launcher notification sheet: inline actions, a Clear control and per-row dismiss.

CHAPTER 17

App Lock

App Lock asks for your fingerprint, face or screen lock before a chosen app opens. It protects apps launched from Nexus; Strict Lock Mode extends that to other ways in.

Set it up in **Settings › App Lock**. Everything on this page applies immediately — there is no Apply button.

How App Lock works

The page opens with a short explanation: locked apps ask for your fingerprint, face or screen lock, and Strict Lock Mode covers other routes into the app.

Authentication required

Setting	Options	Default
Opening locked apps	Every time, Until the phone locks, After 1 minute, After 5 minutes	Until the phone locks
Opening App Lock settings	On / Off — asks once until the phone locks	On
Removing a lock or restoring a backup	On / Off — always asks	On

Hide content

Cover locked apps' widgets replaces a locked app's widget with its name and **Tap to unlock** until you authenticate. While locked, notification content and Nexus Island content for that app read **"Content hidden"**.

Strict Lock Mode

- The toggle is described as locking apps opened from notifications, Recents, links or other launchers.
- Turning it on shows an explanation about the Accessibility service, with **I understand and enable** and **Cancel**. If the service is off, Nexus opens Accessibility settings and finishes enabling when you return.
- **Lock recent apps** hides the recents screen behind authentication. It needs Strict Lock Mode and Accessibility, and warns that a locked app or Recents preview may flash briefly before the lock appears.
- Locking recents works with three-button navigation; gesture navigation is not supported for that one feature.

Choosing apps

- **Individual apps** — a searchable list with a switch per app. Apps already in a lock group are not repeated here.
- **Lock groups** — create a named group and pick its apps. Group rows have their own enable switch, an app count, and Edit and Delete actions. Deleting a group does not change apps locked on their own or in other groups.

Locking from the home screen

Long-press any app — on the home screen, in the dock or in the drawer — and choose **Lock App**. The same menu offers **Unlock App** later, which asks you to confirm your identity first.

> **Set a screen lock first**
>
> App Lock uses your device's own authentication. Without a screen lock, Nexus tells you to set one up before the feature can work.

CHAPTER 18

Search

Search is one field for apps, contacts, sums, conversions and the web. Open it from the drawer's search pill, from a home swipe, from the Search widget, or from the notification sheet's settings shortcuts.

Using it

- The field reads **Search Nexus**.
- With nothing typed, you get **NEW APPS** and **RECENT APPS**, up to eight each.
- Results are grouped as APPS, CONTACTS, CALCULATOR, CONVERSION, WEB and MAPS.
- Two action rows sit at the end: **Search web for "..."** and **Open Maps for "..."**.
- The suggestion chips show examples: **Try: 5km to miles • 25c to f** and **Try: coffee near me • navigate to airport**.

Search settings

Settings › Search has two groups, all on by default:

Group	Toggle	Description shown
Micro Actions	Calculator	Solve mathematical equations directly in search
Micro Actions	Unit Conversion	Convert currency, metrics and units of measurement
Search Sources	Contacts	Show matching device contacts in search results
Search Sources	Web Search	Show web suggestions and the default search engine shortcut
Search Sources	Maps Search	Show a Maps option when the query has no app or contact match

The same toggles are reachable from the gear inside the search overlay, so you can change them without leaving what you were doing.

> **Good queries to try**
>
> **18*7+4** for arithmetic, **12 km to miles** for a conversion, and **coffee near me** for a Maps suggestion. Maps only appears when no app or contact already matched, so it never buries a real result.

Search widget

The Search widget is a compact launcher bar with separate touch targets: the field opens Nexus search, the microphone opens voice search, and larger styles add an apps area, an assistant button and a Lens button. It resizes horizontally only, so it always stays a bar.

CHAPTER 19

News feed and Library

Nexus includes an RSS reader that lives one swipe to the right of your first home page, and a document Library for things you want to read offline.

Opening and turning it off

- **Open:** from the first home page, swipe right.
- **Turn off: Settings › Home Screen › News Feed › Swipe right to access RSS feed**. On by default.

The five tabs

Tab	What it shows
Feed	Your subscriptions, newest first, led by a large hero story
Explore	Curated categories to discover new sources
Saved	Stories you bookmarked
Library	Your documents, with **Add Document**
Settings	Auto-refresh interval, Manage Sources, Add New Source

Reading

- Tap a story to open the reader. The reader is part of Nexus, so it opens inside the app.
- Long-press a card for its menu: save or remove a bookmark, share through Android's share sheet, or hide the story.
- The header menu collapses the feed into a compact headline-only list — two lines of text per story, no images. Your choice is remembered.
- Category chips below the header filter the feed by topic.

Adding sources

In the Settings tab, paste an RSS feed, a website address or a subreddit into **Add New Source**. Active sources can be switched off, deleted, or reordered by dragging. A curated catalog fills in sources you do not have yet.

Library

Add Document imports a PDF, EPUB or text file. Documents open in the Nexus reader and stay on the device.

> **Refreshing**
>
> The feed refreshes when you open it if the configured interval has passed — 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 1 hour, 6 hours or 24 hours.

CHAPTER 20

Backup, restore and sharing

Your layout, folders, widgets and settings can be saved to a single file and restored later or on another phone. Nova Launcher backups can also be imported.

Making a backup

1. Open **Settings › Backup & Restore › Backups**.
2. Set **Backup Location** — choose a folder, internal storage or SD card. Nexus remembers it; if the folder disappears it asks you to choose again.
3. Tap **Back Up Now**. The file appears as a card under **EXISTING BACKUPS**, showing page and item counts.

Restoring

Tap a backup card to enlarge it, then use **Restore**. Nexus warns that the current layout, folders and settings will be replaced and that this cannot be undone. Long-press a card to delete it.

> **Widgets are re-bound, not copied**
>
> A backup stores which widget each item is, not the widget's contents. After restoring, Nexus asks Android to bind each widget again. If something needs your attention, a dialog titled **"Restore needs your attention"** lists each case:
>
> - **App not installed** — that widget is removed from the restored layout.
> - **Needs permission** — Android refused the bind; grant the permission and try again.
> - **Tap it to finish setting up** — the widget's own configuration is still pending.

What a backup contains

- Every home item: apps, folders, shortcuts, widgets, Mosaics, boxes and Canvases, with positions, spans, stacking and padding.
- Folder contents and covers, custom app icons, and gallery wallpapers Nexus itself stored.
- All launcher settings, dock settings, theme, typography, language, feed sources, hidden apps, gesture assignments and App Lock state.
- Notes widget content and per-widget configuration.

Not included: the apps themselves. Target apps must be installed on the new phone, or their icons and widgets cannot appear.

Importing from Nova Launcher

Settings › Backup & Restore › Import from Nova Launcher accepts a `.novabackup` file. The confirmation is explicit about the trade:

> Only app, folder and widget *positions* transfer. Wallpaper, theme, icon pack and gesture settings are **not** imported. The import replaces your current Nexus home screen.

Widgets from a Nova backup go through the same re-bind process as a Nexus backup.

Share your setup

Settings › Share your setup turns your home screen into a shareable image.

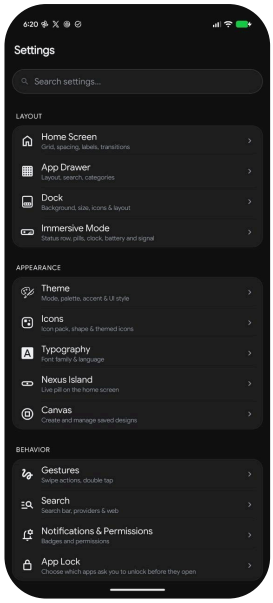
- Uses a live capture of your home screen, or a custom image you supply.
- **Setup settings:** Orientation, Background, Screen corner radius, Show Nexus Launcher logo, Frame (None, Rounded, Border, Phone) and Frame color.
- **Save image** writes a PNG through the system file picker — no storage permission needed. **Share** opens the Android share sheet.

CHAPTER 21

Settings map

Settings opens on a hub with a search field. Type any part of a setting's name — or what it does — and results are split into **Pages** and **Settings**. The list icon at the top right of any page jumps directly to another page without going back to the hub.

Group	Page	What is there
Layout	Home Screen	Grid, spacing, labels, transitions, news feed
	App Drawer	Mode, columns, sort, search pill, categories, rail, hidden apps
	Dock	Size, background, labels, search
	Immersive Mode	Status row, pills, clock, battery, signal
Appearance	Theme	Mode, palette, UI style, background, accent, accessibility
	Icons	Size, shape, icon pack, themed icons
	Typography	Font family, custom fonts, language
	Nexus Island	Pill enablement, calibration, events
	Canvas	Saved designs and Canvas Studio
Behavior	Gestures	Home swipes and action picker
	Search	Micro actions and search sources
	Notifications & Permissions	Badges, history, every permission
	App Lock	Authentication policy, groups, strict mode
System	Backup & Restore	Backups and Nova import
	Share your setup	Shareable home screen image
	Licenses	Font and library licenses
	Privacy policy	Opens the published policy
Feedback	Send feedback	Report a problem or suggest an idea
	Send performance report	Frame times from your last home swipes
	Crash logs	Read or send saved crash reports



The hub: one search field, five groups.

> **Apply is not universal**
>
> Home Screen, App Drawer and Dock stage changes behind an Apply bar. Theme, Typography, Canvas and App Lock apply immediately. The Apply bar simply is not shown on pages that apply immediately, so its absence is not a bug.

CHAPTER 22

Privacy, feedback and diagnostics

Nexus keeps your data on the phone. There is no account, no sign-in and no cloud sync; backups are files you choose the location of.

Privacy policy

Settings › Privacy policy opens the published policy in your browser.

Send feedback

Settings › Send feedback opens a form for problems and ideas.

Performance report

If paging feels slow, open **Send performance report**. It includes frame times from your recent home swipes, plus your version, device, screen and blur decision. If you have not swiped yet, Nexus asks you to swipe a few times first.

Crash logs

After a crash Nexus restarts itself and offers to send a report. The report contains the error, the app version and your phone model. You can read, share or delete saved reports later in **Settings › Crash logs**; an empty list reads **"No crash logs"**.

> **What leaves the device**
>
> Only what you actively send: a crash report, a performance report or feedback. Nothing is uploaded automatically.

CHAPTER 23

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause and fix
Frosted surfaces look flat or plain	Glass needs a captured wallpaper. Use **Capture wallpaper for frost/liquid glass** on the Theme page. Also check that Background Layer is set to Wallpaper, not Theme Color.
No badges on icons	Grant Notification Access in **Notifications & Permissions**, and check that App Icon Badges is not set to Off.
Music widget shows a permission message	It needs Notification Access to read the current track.
Recent apps sections are empty	Grant App Usage Access. Search also offers **Tap to enable Recent Apps**.
Weather asks for location every time	Grant Location Access once; the widget then loads directly.
Widgets missing after a restore	Read the **Restore needs your attention** dialog. Widgets whose app is not installed are removed; others may need a permission or their own setup.
Cannot delete the last home page	By design — a launcher always needs one page. Add another first.
A folder refuses an app	The folder already contains that app. Nexus refuses duplicates rather than creating a second copy.
App Lock flashes an app briefly	Documented behaviour of Strict Lock Mode: a locked app or Recents preview may appear for a moment before the lock covers it.
Recents lock will not turn on	It needs Strict Lock Mode plus Accessibility, and three-button navigation rather than gesture navigation.
Icons jumped after changing columns or rotating	Positions are preserved by proportion and spill into free cells rather than overlapping. Increase rows or columns to give crowded items room.
A gesture does nothing	Check the action assigned in **Gestures**. Lock Screen and some system actions need Accessibility.

Notes on this build

Three details are worth knowing so they are not mistaken for something you did wrong:

- **None** and **Slide** currently animate the same way. If you want the least motion, turn on Reduce Motion as well.
- The radial menu's **Lock Layout** slice changes its own label to a locked state, but does not yet lock the layout.
- The Progress Bar widget exists in the app but is withheld from the picker in this release.

CHAPTER 24

Glossary and setup checklist

Glossary

A–Z rail

The alphabet strip on the drawer's edge. Drag along it to jump to a letter.

Canvas

A free-form design board placed on a home page, built from text, live values, widgets, apps, shapes and images.

Frost capture

A one-time snapshot of a wallpaper Nexus did not set itself, used so glass surfaces can blur it.

Home page

The page the Home button returns to. Set it from a Manage Pages card.

Immersive Mode

Hides Android's system bars and draws Nexus's own status row.

Living Mosaic

A widget container holding several widgets across pages, with Mosaic and Focus display modes.

Nexus Island

An optional capsule over the camera cutout that expands to show events.

Radial menu

The eight-slice menu that opens when you long-press empty home space.

Strict Lock Mode

Extends App Lock to apps opened from notifications, Recents, links and other launchers.

UI Style

How surfaces are drawn: Default, Frosted Glass, Neumorphism or Liquid Glass.

First-week checklist

Work through this at your own pace. Each item is independent.

- □ Set Nexus as the default Home app.
- □ Grant Notification Access if you want badges and the notification sheet.
- □ Choose a theme mode and one UI Style you like.
- □ Pick an accent colour, or turn the accent off for a neutral look.
- □ Set your grid: columns, rows, icon size and label style.
- □ Pick a drawer mode and a sort order.
- □ Decide whether the dock stays visible or gives its space to the grid.
- □ Create one folder for the apps you use together.
- □ Place one widget you will actually look at.

- [ ] Turn on Immersive Mode and pick a status row preset.
- [ ] Assign the two home swipes to what you expect them to do.
- [ ] Make a backup once the layout feels right.

> **One last thing**
>
> Every setting in this manual is reversible. If an experiment goes wrong, Reset on the relevant page, or a backup, puts things back.

Nexus Launcher User Guide · covers version 1.0.2 · October 2026.

Feature names and paths in this manual were checked against the application source. Every illustration is rendered in CSS from the launcher's own visual language, not photographed from a device.